

### **1. User Account Management:**

- **Disable Root Login:** Never log in directly as "root". Use sudo for administrative tasks to prevent accidental system-wide damage.
- **Strong Passwords:** Ensure all user accounts use complex passwords (min 12 chars, mixed case, special characters).
- **Remove Unused Accounts:** Regularly audit /etc/passwd to remove employees who have left or test accounts that are no longer needed.

### **2. File Permissions & Access Control:**

- **Apply Least Privilege:** Users should only have the permissions strictly necessary for their role.
- **Audit World-Writable Files:** Ensure crucial system files are not set to 777 (writable by anyone).
- Command: find / -xdev -type d -perm -0002 -print
- **Secure SSH Keys:** Ensure .ssh directories have 700 permissions (only the owner can access).

### **3. Network & Firewall Configuration:**

- **Enable Firewall:** Ensure the host-based firewall is active to block unsolicited incoming traffic.
- Linux Command: sudo ufw enable
- **Windows Action:** Turn on Windows Defender Firewall for all network profiles (Domain, Private, Public).
- **Close Unused Ports:** If the server is not a web server, close ports 80 and 443. Only keep necessary ports open (e.g., Port 22 for SSH).

### **4. Service Management (Attack Surface Reduction):**

- **Disable Unnecessary Services:** Turn off services that are not required for the system's function (e.g., FTP, Telnet, Print Spooler on a web server).
- Linux Command: systemctl disable [service\_name]
- **Update Regularly:** Keep the OS and all installed packages patched to the latest versions to fix known vulnerabilities.
- Linux Command: sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade